

and uploading newer pages you might require FTP access to your Web space—this is faster than the GUI Web interface. Most free Web space providers don't offer FTP access. It's usually reserved for professional and other paid package schemes. **Yahoo Geocities** closed down its offer of free FTP access from April 2, 2002, as it went paid on some of its services. But there are exceptions too. You just have to do some hunting around.

Site search engine

You could make your Web site a repository of all your intelligence and knowledge. Now what if someone wants to search your knowledge store for something specific? Does your free service provider offer you the facility of searching your site? Check

on it before registering with a hosting service. **Freeservers.com** offers a site search engine as well as a search engine that can search across similar sites.

Site builder

If you are a novice on the Web you might prefer some kind of guidance. While registering for a free hosting service check if the service provider will assist you with site building templates and tools. Most service providers do that as a part of their effort to promote their services.

Site copier

This is a feature that's available with **www.freeservers.com**. Imagine you have your site hosted elsewhere on the Web. Copying those files one-by-one to your **freeservers.com** account would be a tedious process. Site copier helps you copy all your files from your earlier hosting space into your **freeservers.com** space in a jiffy. Once the files have been moved, the site becomes available in your new account and you can start working on them.

Forwarding e-mail

Certain sites provide you with free e-mail services while others don't. The ones that do, provide a mail-forwarding service. When you have registered a domain such as **tintinsclone.freeservers.com** and someone sends a mail to **anyname@tintinsclone.freeservers.com**, it will be auto-

matically forwarded to the e-mail address that you entered in your membership details. You need to activate the e-mail forwarding facility before you can actually use it. If you plan to distribute the mail you receive to other individuals, then enter an e-groups mail ID to which all of them have subscribed. Whatever mail you receive at your site will then be forwarded to all the subscribers.

Sundry features

Other features that you could possibly look for could be free site statistics, site counters, message boards, guest books and form e-mailers. Most free hosting sites provide these features. Choose the best from the options you have.

Monthly bandwidth

Data is sent back and forth when visitors enter and leave your site. Your monthly bandwidth is the total amount of data transferred from your hosting space to all the visitors' computers. Since bandwidth is a main cost factor involved in hosting, free services limit the bandwidth offered. **Yahoo Geocities** offers you a maximum bandwidth of 3 GB per month.

Cheap deals

The facilities offered by free hosting service providers are restricted. It's advisable to opt for cheap paid services

Cheap domains

Most Netizens would prefer



Host it yourself

If you are a Cable Internet/DSL subscriber and have a dedicated IP, you don't have to bother with free hosting or buying Web space. You can host all the content on your computer and direct all requests to your domain name to your computer's static IP. There is a downside to this—be prepared for huge electricity bills.

having their own online identity. Domain name registrars allow you to register your preferred name. Offers range from Rs 350 to over Rs 1,000 depending on the service.

The cheapest and probably most reliable of all services is **www.net4domains.com**. You can register your domain name for just Rs 445 a year. Of course, a 10-year deal for Rs 4,450 will be economical if you wish to maintain a site that you can hand over to your successor. What's more, you get two free e-mail IDs on any booking made with **Net4domains**.

Search for your domain name. If it's available, book it on the Web site and send a cheque or demand draft to **Net4domains** as instructed on the site or in the confirmation e-mail that you receive. Your domain will be registered only after your payment is received and will remain active for the registered period only.



Smart coding

■ Do not use any WYSIWYG editors such as MS FrontPage or Netscape Composer. They might change the script you are copying and it's possible that errors might occur on your Web page. Use a normal text editor such as Notepad to do HTML inclusions/exclusions.

■ If you know a bit of HTML you can use frames to load message boards and guest books within your main site. Check out **www.wdvl.com** for more information.



Virus Alerts, Bug Fixes, Patches, Security

Virus Workshop

www.zdnetindia.com/virus